

<u>Misinformation Moderation by Social Media Platforms (1)</u>	
Title	On "non-reportability": Russian disinformation, election interference, and blind spots in platform governance
Output of the Project	A pattern analysis identifying Coordinated Inauthentic Behaviour (CIB) across Dutch political Telegram channels, where content copied from the Russian state-linked outlet Pravda was amplified without source attribution, with activity spikes mapped to specific windows before and during the Dutch elections, using Excel and Osavul for cross-platform pattern interpretation.
Outcome of the Project	Findings were incorporated into a formal report submitted to the Dutch Ministry of the Interior, directly informing government and academic understanding of platform-level election interference and shaping further research into this area. (https://www.digitalmethods.net/Dmi/FallSpring2025Pravda).
Your role in the Project	First hands-on exposure to applied data interpretation: identified activity patterns across platforms and correlated them to election-period timing using Excel and Osavul (https://www.osavul.cloud/about) softwares.
Description	1. A significant spike was noticed in specific Telegram groups of parties where information was copied and shared from a Russian news source (Pravda) without revealing the source. 2. The project was part of a report submitted to the Dutch Ministry of Interior (https://www.rijksoverheid.nl/documenten/2025/06/23/evaluatie-contentmoderatie-2025)
Aspects transferable to the Industry	AI models can be used to train and analyse massive datasets to scan through data and understand how the data is affecting the opinions of the general public. The same method can be applied to a service or product or policy launched by an industry/government to see how customers/citizens respond to the product/policy.

<u>Misinformation Moderation by Social Media Platforms (2)</u>	
Title	Russian traces in the 2025 Dutch elections
Output of the Project	A timestamp-based investigation using Osavul that documented coordinated campaigning and search-engine manipulation, tracing subtle headline-wording changes between Pravda's original stories and their reposted versions on Telegram channels such as REST Media. (https://www.osavul.cloud/about)
Outcome of the Project	Evidence of coordinated headline manipulation was included in the same formal report submitted to the Dutch Ministry of the Interior, strengthening the government's evidentiary basis for understanding cross-platform disinformation tactics around the election. (https://www.digitalmethods.net/Dmi/FallSpring2025Pravda).
Your role in the Project	Researched search-engine manipulation by working through Osavul timestamp data to identify recurring wording patterns between Pravda and affiliated Telegram channels.
Description	1. Headline wording was subtly altered between the original Pravda posts and their Telegram reposts, and these altered versions were then shared aggressively by the receiving channels. 2. The project was part of a report submitted to the Dutch Ministry of Interior (https://www.rijksoverheid.nl/documenten/2025/06/23/evaluatie-contentmoderatie-2025)
Aspects transferable to the Industry	The same dataset-scanning approach used to trace narrative manipulation across sources can be applied by any organization to monitor how its own messaging is being altered, amplified, or misrepresented as it spreads across channels.

<u>Cultural Geometries of the Manosphere</u>	
Title	r/MGTOW: Consensual Hallucinations of Gynocentrism in an Interpretive Community
Output of the Project	1. A corpus-linguistics and cultural-geometry analysis of eighteen years of r/MGTOW

	discourse (2004–2022), using concordance and collocation analysis, topic modelling, and word embeddings to map user attitudes across three antonym-pair dimensions with a pre-trained language model. 2. Co-wrote a paper
Outcome of the Project	Demonstrated that the community functions as a self-reinforcing “interpretive community” operating on a shared belief system detached from empirical reality — a reframing, grounded in Stanley Fish's and William Gibson's concepts of interpretive community and consensual hallucination, that offers a transferable lens for diagnosing radicalization-adjacent online communities beyond simple content-flagging.
Your role in the Project	1. Applied corpus linguistics, topic modelling, word embedding, and cultural geometry methods to analyze the dataset, then connected the findings to established theory to reach a defined conclusion.
Description	1. The dataset spans a specific fifteen-year period (2004–2022) within a single group (r/MGTOW), analyzed using a pre-trained language model.
Aspects transferable to the Industry	Online consumer behaviour is increasingly shaped by individualized, opaque algorithms. Organizations with API access to this kind of data can combine topic modelling, cultural geometry, and corpus linguistics — supported by agentic LLM-based analysis — to build sharper, evidence-based strategy.

<u>Appification of AI</u>	
Title	Governing Companionship? A Comparative Study of Policy, Interface, and Interaction in AI Companion Apps
Output of the Project	A comparative walkthrough and interaction test of four AI companion apps (Kindroid, Nomi, Character AI, Replika) against three different scenarios using a walkthrough style stress testing framework to benchmark the actual app's behaviour against each app's advertised safety policies and governance claims.

Outcome of the Project	Revealed a consistent gap between marketed safety guardrails and real app behaviour — most pronounced in free-tier apps — surfacing a governance blind spot directly relevant to how companies design AI consent and safety frameworks under regulatory scrutiny such as EU GDPR and app-store policy requirements.
Your role in the Project	1. Conducted a structured app walkthrough of four AI companion apps, customized the AI environment to a mental-health scenario, and ran interaction tests evaluating whether AI behaviour complied with each app's governance and marketing claims.
Description	The study examined how easily an AI could be manipulated to serve malicious or dangerous user intent, and how effective the advertised safety guardrails actually were in practice.
Aspects transferable to the Industry	AI features embedded in consumer apps must comply with government regulation (EU GDPR) and app store policy (Google Play, App Store). Terms and conditions covering AI features need precise, carefully audited wording — and companies benefit from testing their own claims the way this project tested these four.

<u>Thesis</u>	
Title	Digital Shards in Issue Space of South Asian Immigration: An Algorithmic Autoethnography of Recommended Feed and Auto-Netnographic study of Remediation through Comments
Output of the Project	An algorithmic autoethnography and netnographic study combining Pix Plot visualization, Gephi issue-network mapping, image/video walls, and stack video visualization to trace how Instagram's recommendation logic fragments (“shards”) the immigration discourse across posts and comment threads.
Outcome of the Project	The AI of social media platforms promotes a Dynamic Valorization of Content by manipulating the users fear of missing out. The majority opinion of any issue shared through other affordances like liking, commenting and sharing influences how the issue space completely remediates into an event that

	has happened in the past to an event that does not subside or die down.
Your role in the Project	1. Collected data from Instagram by understanding the behaviour of Meta AI using the affordance of saving posts to understand the issue space. 2. Analyzed data using methods like Pix Plot Visualization, Issue Network visualization using Gephi, Image and Video Walls and Stack Video Visualization.
Description	Such an angle helps in understanding the psychology of the users who are being exposed to highly individualized AI based feed. Therefore, finding a common strategy and methods to adapt it continuously for a dynamically changing AI that influences a massive number of customers/citizens is the need of the hour for every company/government.
Aspects transferable to the Industry	Understanding how “blackboxed” social-platform AI shapes what audiences see helps organizations and governments anticipate how their own messaging will be filtered and reshaped — and build strategies that adapt quickly and efficiently when the algorithm shifts.